

LEGISLATURE OF THE STATE OF IDAHO
Sixty-eighth Legislature Second Regular Session - 2026

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
HOUSE CONCURRENT RESOLUTION NO. 31

BY WAYS AND MEANS COMMITTEE

A CONCURRENT RESOLUTION

STATING FINDINGS OF THE LEGISLATURE AND RECOGNIZING AND COMMENDING THE LIFE-
TIME ACHIEVEMENTS OF LINDEN B. BATEMAN, FOUNDER OF IDAHO DAY, WHO SERVED
IN THE IDAHO HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES WITH HONOR AND DISTINCTION.

Be It Resolved by the Legislature of the State of Idaho:

WHEREAS, Linden B. Bateman was born on July 11, 1940, in Salt Lake City, Utah and spent his life in Idaho Falls, Idaho. He graduated from Idaho Falls High School in the Class of 1958; and

WHEREAS, Linden obtained a degree in political science from Brigham Young University in 1962 and then served a mission for the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-Day Saints (LDS) in Northern Germany from 1962-1965; and

WHEREAS, Linden's mission inspired a lifelong love for Germany, the German people, culture, and language. Linden spoke and read German and returned to Germany several times to visit friends he made while living there; and

WHEREAS, while at Brigham Young University, Linden met Deann Willes of Maywood, California. They were married on January 19, 1965 in the Switzerland LDS Temple. Linden and Deann celebrated their 61st anniversary on January 19, 2026; and

WHEREAS, while living near Iona, Linden raised Clydesdale horses and showed horses at fairs throughout the region, treasuring the memories of horse-drawn carriage rides at Christmastime; and

WHEREAS, Linden was a member of the first faculty at Skyline High School when it opened in 1966 and later taught government and history at Bonneville High School for 34 years; and

WHEREAS, Linden's passion for American government and history and his love of Idaho were enthusiastically shared with his students during his long teaching career, leaving a lasting positive impact on thousands of lives; and

WHEREAS, after retiring from teaching, Linden worked for seven years as a supervisor of student teachers at BYU-Idaho and Idaho State University; and

WHEREAS, Linden volunteered hundreds of hours of service in the emergency room at the Eastern Idaho Regional Medical Center; and

WHEREAS, Linden loved Idaho and local history. He was a charter member of the Bonneville County Historical Society, which evolved into the "Museum of Idaho," one of the state's premier history museums; and

WHEREAS, Linden was elected to the Idaho House of Representatives for six terms from 1976 to 1986 and three terms from 2010 to 2016. He was elected for two terms in House leadership as House Majority Caucus Chairman; and

WHEREAS, Linden had beautiful handwriting and wrote hundreds of richly illustrated letters using vintage-style pens, stationery, and old postage

1 stamps. In 2014, he sponsored legislation to restore the teaching of cursive
2 handwriting in public schools; and

3 WHEREAS, Linden published numerous articles on topics of local and
4 Idaho history. He was an enthusiastic collector of historical memorabilia
5 and was known throughout Idaho as "Mr. History;" and

6 WHEREAS, Linden drew humorous political cartoons and caricatures of his
7 legislative colleagues, some of which were featured in Idaho newspapers; and

8 WHEREAS, Linden received many commendations for his teaching and public
9 service, including an award from the 7th District Bar Association, recogniz-
10 ing his creative excellence in the teaching of American Government; and

11 WHEREAS, Linden was the author, sponsor, and successful advocate for
12 the law designating March 4th as "Idaho Day," remembering Abraham Lincoln's
13 creation of Idaho Territory on that day in 1863; and

14 WHEREAS, Linden was a guest speaker in the House and Senate Idaho Day
15 celebrations every year; and

16 WHEREAS, Linden Bateman passed away in Idaho Falls on January 22, 2026.

17 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the members of the Second Regular Ses-
18 sion of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, the House of Representatives and
19 the Senate concurring therein, that the lifetime achievements of Linden B.
20 Bateman, founder of "Idaho Day," be recognized and commended.